Metro City Premier League — Official Rulebook (2026 Season)

1. Overview

The Metro City Premier League (MCPL) is a fictional 12-team indoor football league. All rules below are fictional and used for demonstration only.

2. Match Format

Each match consists of two halves of 25 minutes each, with a 10-minute half-time break.
A team fields 6 players on the pitch at any time: 1 goalkeeper and 5 outfield players.
If a match ends level in the knockout stage, two 5-minute periods of extra time are played, followed by a penalty shootout if still level.

3. Scoring

A goal scored from open play is worth 1 point.
A goal scored directly from a corner kick (an "olimpico") is worth 2 points.
Own goals count as 1 point to the opposing team.

4. Fouls and Penalties

A yellow card is shown for reckless challenges. Two yellow cards in one match result in a red card.
A red card results in the player being sent off, and the team plays with one fewer player for the remainder of the match.
A player who receives a red card is automatically suspended for the next 1 match. A violent-conduct red card carries a 3-match suspension.

5. Substitutions

Each team may make up to 5 substitutions per match.
Substitutions are "rolling": a substituted player may return to the pitch later in the same match.
The goalkeeper may be substituted at any stoppage in play.

6. Player Eligibility

A player must be at least 16 years old on the first day of the season to be eligible.
Each squad may register a maximum of 18 players and a minimum of 10 players.
A player may only be registered to one club per season.

7. Standings and Tie-Breakers

Teams earn 3 points for a win, 1 point for a draw, and 0 points for a loss.
If two teams are level on league points, the tie is broken in this order:
1. Goal difference
2. Total goals scored
3. Head-to-head result
4. A one-off playoff match at a neutral venue

8. Discipline and Appeals

A club may appeal a red card within 48 hours of the final whistle.
The Disciplinary Committee must rule on an appeal within 5 business days.
Frivolous appeals may be fined up to 500 league credits.